

Ethics Commission Meeting April 9th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mGEslltDWnI
Publication Date	2025-04-10T10:35:48Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Ethics Commission

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Jim Low called the April meeting of the Muncie Ethics Commission to order at [00:00:35](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chip Taylor, Susan Dylan, WC Edwards, Sandra Whitaker, and Jim Low (Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not present in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the previous meeting were presented from board packets, motioned for acceptance, seconded by WC Edwards, and approved by voice vote ([00:00:51](#)).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:01:21](#) Adoption of Public Hearing Procedures

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim Low (Chair) / City Attorney Aubrey Christ
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission reviewed the final draft of procedures for holding public hearings, modeled after Bloomington's human rights commission procedures with feedback from City Attorney Aubrey Christ. Key changes from the previous month included:
 - Streamlining stylistic bullet points in the notice content section (Roman Numeral II).
 - Limiting discovery methods (Roman Numeral VI) strictly to written interrogatories and production of documents, removing expansive rules and protective/enforcement orders deemed overkill.
 - Adding a blanket requirement that witnesses be separated during hearings to prevent coordination (Roman Numeral VIII C2).
 - Renaming the "suggested decision" to "proposed findings of fact and conclusions of law" for legal clarity (Roman Numeral XI).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote (00:06:44).

00:07:00 New Business: Vendor Disclosure Form for Relative Contracts

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim Low / City Attorney's Office
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission discussed implementing a vendor disclosure form regarding contracts with city relatives. State law mandates disclosures for contracts involving relatives of the mayor or city council, and local ordinances expand this to appointed officials and employees. The proposed form modeled after AIM (Accelerated Indiana Municipalities) guidance would be integrated into the Board of Works bid and contract packages. Discussion focused on due diligence, managing instances where vendors or employees are unaware of distant familial ties, and the distinction between standard disclosures and actual financial conflicts of interest.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote taken; the item was held over for further refinement and scheduled to be brought back for final adoption at the next meeting (00:19:49).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: The transcript does not feature a formal open public comment period or public forum section involving outside residents; discussions were strictly confined to board members and city staff.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The commission discussed potential redaction checklists for complaints to protect sensitive personal and law enforcement officer information (such as home addresses), noting consultation with past public access counselor guidance.
 - Board members and staff agreed to share purchasing thresholds and guidelines ahead of the May meeting to evaluate city purchasing transparency and consistency across departments.
 - **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and approved by voice vote (00:31:19).
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